



Animation Production Pipeline

Welcome to Our Production Process Guide

Here's our streamlined sprint roadmap, guiding you through the key stages of animation production and offering a behind-the-scenes view as your project progresses. It also highlights critical stages where your valuable input is essential, ensuring we make the right decisions together.

Animation Production Lifecycle

Requirement Acquisition and Initiation

This phase involves gathering essential information, clearly defining the project scope, and finalizing requirements. The Production POC collaborates with the Customer Project Manager to ensure all details have been covered, confirming readiness for project execution. It consists of four stages to ensure clarity.

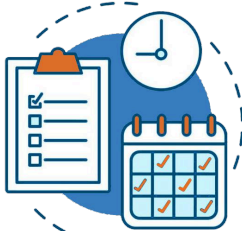
- 1) Define Project Scope
- 2) Data Collection
- 3) Analysis and Review
- 4) Requirement Finalized



Project Definition and Planning

This phase establishes a roadmap, ensuring requirements are production-ready and aligned with the client's scope. Approved scripts and storyboards become the foundation for subsequent phases, guiding production toward timely delivery. It is divided into four stages for clarity and alignment.

- 1) Define Script
- 2) Create Animation Plan/ Storyboard
- 3) Estimation and Budget Allocation
- 4) Communication & Project Review



Pre-Production and Initiation (Parallel to Estimation & Budgeting)

This phase runs parallel to project definition and planning and involves the animation team. It focuses on resource preparation, workflow setup, and team alignment to ensure a smooth transition to full-scale production.

- 1) Reading and Understanding
- 2) Project Planning & Discussion
- 3) Shot allocation
- 4) Project Estimation





Project Production

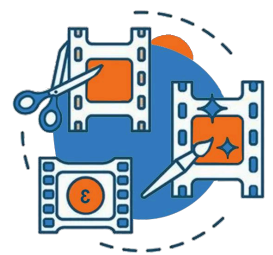
This is the phase where production officially begins, and the core team starts executing the plan. The necessary materials are gathered in preparation for the build, and through a series of production steps, the concept starts to take shape. The production process includes the following stages:

- 1) File Collection
- 2) Modelling
- 3) Staging
- 4) Rigging
- 5) Animatics
- 6) Simulation
- 7) Texturing & lighting

Post Production

This is the final stage of the animation process, where the animation is rendered and compiled into a video format. At this stage, every element that influences the visual style and feel of the animation is fine-tuned. Additionally, video editing enhancements are added to make the final video more dynamic and engaging.

- 1) Rendering & Comping
- 2) VFX and Audio matching
- 3) Final Delivery



Guidelines

- Please use the following form to provide the details needed to enable us to plan the production of your animation - it serves as a checklist to ensure all items are addressed during initial discussions between all parties involved. This form helps streamline the process by consolidating client data in one centralized location at the beginning of the project, reducing the risk of scattered information across multiple storage locations, platforms and timelines.

Animation Requirement Checklist

- Once the form is submitted, the data is automatically recorded in a spreadsheet, and the corresponding requirement documents are securely saved in a designated online folder.

Stages of Animation Production

A professional walkthrough of the essential stages in animation production, offering clear insights into the workflow, key milestones, and the collaborative efforts required to bring your creative vision to life.

Project Definition and Planning



Define Script

The script can be drafted by the client, but this is often more challenging than expected. Our recommendation for the client is to provide as many bullet points and descriptions of their vision as they can, accompanied by images and reference material, then the script is drafted by Service Visuals Subject Matter Expert (SME) based on these details and the requirements documents gathered from the client during the “Requirement Acquisition and Initiation” phase.

Once the first draft is produced it undergoes a review process, which may involve revisions or edits before final approval by the client.

Below you will find some timing estimates, which are good for all parties to review and understand. They include estimates of time taken to write a script, time needed to write a draft animation plan based on the script agreed and an approximate video duration based on script length.

Word Count	Time Needed to write script	Time Needed to write draft Animation Plan	Approximate Duration of Animation
Upto 250	1 day	0.5 day	≤1min
250–500	1.5 days	0.5 days	1–2 mins
500–700	2 days	1.5 days	2–5 mins
750–1000	3 days	2 days	5–8 mins
1000–1500	3–5 days (inclusive of revision)	2–3 days	8–15 mins

** Disclaimer: The animation length is provided as a range, accounting for pauses and variations depending on the speaker and the complexity of the topic being discussed.*



Animation Plan/ Storyboard

The animation plan or storyboard serves as the director's notes for the animators. It includes details such as what will be shown on screen, camera positions and angles, and parts of the on-screen content which will be the focus for key topics based on the script.



Estimation and Budget Allocation

With an agreed script and/or animation plan, the project is assigned to the animation team, and task-based estimates are derived and incorporated into the animation plan. This step is essential for establishing the expected timeframes, a due date, and proposed budget. It is worth noting that final project delivery estimates vary based on the desired video definition - this is due to rendering times differing significantly between 4K (UHD), 1080p (TrueHD), and 720p (HD).



Communication & Project Review

With estimates and pricing determined, final approval from the client is obtained, and review milestones throughout the animation production process are established. Agreed modes of communication are defined prior to project commencement.

Pre-Production and Initiation



Reading and Understanding

The finalised animation plan is read carefully to ensure the animation team fully understands the requirements.



Project Planning & Discussion

The project is assigned to specific individuals and teams, and completion date estimates for each part of the project are derived and incorporated into the animation plan.



Shot allocation

Shots and roles are assigned to individuals in the animation team, ensuring the right skills are matched to achieve the best turnaround time and efficient delivery.

Project Production

1. File Collection

The animation team gathers and organizes essential assets, including the important reference materials provided by the client and any additional resources sourced through their own research.

2. Modeling

The animation team creates detailed 3D models of the external subject matter of the animation and any internal components needed to follow the requirements of the script.

3. Staging:

The animation team arranges scenes to highlight important details and to match the narrative.

4. Rigging:

The animation team create a control system for realistic movement of the subject (eg vehicle, human body etc)

5. Animation

The animation team provides a blueprint for the final animation.

6. Simulation

Using principles of physics for realistic dynamics and reactions, the animation team simulate movement.

7. Texturing & Lightning

In order to add realism and set the scene's tone, careful texturing of the subjects, the addition of realistic lighting and appropriate background are added.

8. Compositing

The final stage of production is the blending of all elements, the addition of effects, and polishing for final delivery is completed.

Review Process

1. Manager & SME Quality Check

In-depth reviews are conducted by the animation manager and SME at each stage of production, to ensure technical accuracy and good quality. This is given a final review before release to the client for their review and final approval.

2. Client Approval

The client reviews and provides feedback, before final minor revisions are made.

What additional data would help a distributor with client acquisition?

Eg, Script writing durations

1. Perhaps a cost breakdown for voiceover recordings—based on word count and past Fiverr orders. Rather than just listing costs from individual orders, we could establish our own categorization for reference.
2. Project delivery estimates vary based on the desired file output, as rendering times differ between 4K (Ultra HD), 1080p (True HD), and 720p (HD), with 4K being the most time-consuming.

Frequently Asked Question

1. Is it possible to show the component detached into sub parts and include labels and callouts?
2. Is it possible to show the component detached into sub parts
3. Can you animate with a cutaway of the component, such that we can see the internals.
4. What are all the services you provide in addition to 3D animation creation ?
5. Can you add a voiceover ?